

As a broad benchmark, a 10 TPD MRF typically operates with ~16–18 workers, distributed as:

<i>Role</i>	<i>Key Responsibilities</i>	<i>Cross-training potential</i>	<i>Number of Personnel</i>
Sorter	• Primary sorting of incoming waste into designated material categories at sorting station or conveyor • Visual identification of material types; separation of recyclables, rejects, and special-handling material (e-waste, hazardous) • Pre-baling quality check - removing contaminants from sorted category bags before handing to baling staff • Maintaining cleanliness of sorting station and designated storage compartments • Reporting unusual materials, hazardous items, or quality concerns immediately to supervisor	Collection, loading/unloading, gate-grading	8-10
Loader/unloader	• Unloading incoming vehicles at the transfer point into designated intake zones • Moving sorted material bags to the baling area once filled • Loading baled material onto dispatch vehicles; covering and securing with plastic sheet and ropes • Maintaining clear traffic routes; ensures intake and dispatch zones are not obstructed	Forklift operations, dispatch assistance	2-3
Machine operator	• Operating baling machine - feeding sorted material, controls cycle, ties and tags completed bales • Operating conveyor belt where applicable - controls speed, clears minor blockages • Daily pre-operation equipment check; logging any faults or abnormal sounds in maintenance register • Never operating machine if safety guard is missing or damaged - escalating to supervisor immediately • Pre-baling scan for sharp or oversized items that could damage the baler (glass, metal rods, large hardware)	Forklift operations, supervision	1-2
Forklift operator	• Moving completed bales from baling area to storage and from storage to dispatch vehicle • Operating only in designated forklift lanes	Loading/unloading, basic	1

	Not applicable at small-scale or low-mechanised facilities - role absorbed by loaders using manual trolleys	machine support	
Supervisor	- Opening facility and leading daily precheck - Managing worker deployment: assigning roles, filling absentee gaps - First escalation point for safety incidents, machine faults, and worker grievances	Sorting, machine operations, record keeping	1
Collector	- Route-based collection from households, commercial establishments, and bulk generators - First-level source segregation enforcement - Flagging unusual material (hazardous, e-waste) to supervisor before unloading at MRF - Acting on-ground for community engagement - notifying supervisor of segregation improvement or deterioration in a route	Sorting, loading/unloading, community mobilizing	2-3
Record-keeper/ data entry admin	- Maintaining all mandatory registers - Consolidating attendance records for payroll; submitting monthly wage sheets - Organising photo documentation folders by date and source - Preparing monthly reports for ULB, EPR, or funder reporting requirements	Supervision, basic machine operations and support	1

The table above provides a complete breakdown of workforce required for a 10 TPD baseline, detailing each role's headcount, day-to-day responsibilities, and cross-training potential for handling absenteeism. This is made for a 10 TPD semi-mechanised MRF – use this as a reference baseline. Adjust headcount proportionally to your throughput, mechanisation level, and feedstock mix.